“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 2

The Auspicious Invocation Indicating the Object: Determining the Truth of Caitanya

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

1 I worship Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, by whose mercy even an ignorant child can cross the ocean of philosophical conclusions, which teems with the crocodiles of various doctrines.[1]

2 O Śrī Caitanya, ocean of mercy! May the celestial Gaṅgā of the nectar of Your shining pastimes flow over the desert of my tongue. She is adorned with the lotuses of the loud glorification of Kṛṣṇa, of singing and of dancing; she is the place of delight for the rows of true devotees, who are like swans, cakravāka birds and bees; and her sweet murmur gladdens the ear.[2]

3 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

4 Now I shall explain in detail the meaning of the third verse. It is an auspicious invocation that points to the Supreme Truth (*vastu-nirdeśa*).[3]

5 “There is no Truth in the world higher than Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. That which the Upaniṣads call the non-dual Brahman is the effulgence of His body; the Puruṣa, the Supersoul who dwells within every heart, is His partial manifestation; and Bhagavān, full in all six opulences, is He Himself.”[4]

6 Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān are the three *anuvādas* (that which is spoken of); the effulgence of the body, the partial manifestation and His own form are the three *vidheyas* (that which is stated about them).[5]

7 First the *anuvāda* is stated, and afterwards the *vidheya* is set down. In this way I shall tell the meaning of the verse; hear now the explanation according to scripture.

8 Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself, the supreme truth among all forms of Viṣṇu (*viṣṇu-tattva*). He is fullness of knowledge, fullness of bliss and the highest greatness.[6]

9 He whom the *Bhāgavatam* glorifies as the son of Nanda — that same Kṛṣṇa has descended as Śrī Caitanya Gosāñi.

10 In His particular manifestations He bears three names: Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān Himself.

11 “The knowers of the Truth call the non-dual knowledge the Truth; it is named Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.2.11)[7]

12 That which the Upaniṣads call the spotless Brahman is the pure radiance of the rays of His body.

13 As the sun appears to fleshly eyes as mere brilliance without features, so on the path of knowledge one cannot perceive His particular features.

14 “I worship Govinda, the original Person. Brahman — undivided, infinite and complete, distinct from all the opulences of countless universes, their earths and all else — is the effulgence of Him, the Almighty.” (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.40)[8]

15 That Brahman whose glory is spread through millions upon millions of universes is the radiance of Govinda's body.

16 I worship that Govinda; He is my Lord. By His grace I (Brahmā) have the power to create.

17 "Sages clothed by the wind, ascetics who keep their seed drawn upward, peaceful, pure renunciants — they go to the abode called Brahman." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.6.47)[9]

18 The Supersoul, the Indweller, of whom the scriptures of yoga speak, is a partial manifestation of Govinda.[10]

19 As one sun is reflected in countless crystals, so Govinda's portion, the Supersoul, is manifest in every living being.[11]

20 "But what need have you, Arjuna, of all this detailed knowledge? By one portion of Myself I pervade and support this entire universe." (Bhagavad-gītā, 10.42)[12]

21 (Grandsire Bhīṣma said:) "O Śrī Kṛṣṇa! Having cast off the illusion of 'difference' between all Your forms, I have attained You, the Unborn, who abide in the heart of each of the embodied beings You have created — like the one sun, which each eye sees in its own way." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.9.42)[13]

22 That very Govinda is Śrī Caitanya Gosāñi Himself. There is none so merciful in delivering the souls.[14]

23 In the spiritual sky dwells the Lord called Nārāyaṇa — Bhagavān, full in the six opulences, the beloved of Lakṣmī.

24 He whom the Vedas, the *Bhāgavatam*, the Upaniṣads and the Āgamas call “the complete Truth”, and who has no equal —

25 Him the devotees behold through bhakti-yoga, as the gods behold the sun in its own form.[15]

26 Those who worship Him on the paths of knowledge and yoga realise Him as Brahman and as the Supersoul.

27 By the differences in worship we know the greatness of the Lord; that is why He is compared to the sun.

28 That Nārāyaṇa is not different from Kṛṣṇa’s own form: They are one and the same Person, differing only in shape.

29 This One has two arms, while that One has four; this One holds the flute, that One the disc and the other emblems.[16]

30 “Are You not Nārāyaṇa? For You are the Self of all embodied beings, O Lord, and the witness of all the worlds. Nārāyaṇa is Your portion — so called because His abode is the waters born of Nara; and that too is true, not Your māyā.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.14.14)[17]

31 Having stolen the boys and the calves, Brahmā had committed an offence; to have it forgiven, he begged for mercy:

32 “From the lotus of Your navel I was born; You are my father and mother, and I am Your son.

33 A father and mother do not hold a child’s offences against him. Forgive my offence and be merciful to me.”

34 Kṛṣṇa said: “Brahmā, your father is Nārāyaṇa. I am a cowherd boy — how can you be My son?”

35 Brahmā said: “Are You not Nārāyaṇa? You are Nārāyaṇa — hear the reason.

36 You are the Self of all living beings, as many as there are in the material and spiritual creation; You are their original source.[18]

37 As the earth is the cause and the support of all earthen pots, so You are the cause of all souls, and You are the shelter of all.

38 The word *nāra* means the aggregate of all souls, and the word *ayana* means their shelter.

39 Therefore You are the original Nārāyaṇa. That is one reason; hear now the second.

40 The Puruṣas and the other avatāras are the lords of the souls, but Your majesty is unlimited, greater than that of Them all.

41 Therefore You are the supreme Lord, the father of all; it is by Your power that They protect the world.

42 Since You protect those who are the shelter of the nāras, You are the original Nārāyaṇa.

43 Hear the third reason, O Śrī Bhagavān. There are unlimited universes and many abodes — the Vaikuṇṭhas and others.

44 All the beings in them, and their deeds in past, present and future — You see it all; You are the witness, You know the heart of everything.

45 By Your glance all the worlds exist; if You did not look on them, nothing could either stand or move.

46 Since You see the ways of all the nāras, by that too You are the original Nārāyaṇa.”

47 Kṛṣṇa said: “Brahmā, I do not understand your words. Nārāyaṇa is He who dwells in the hearts of living beings and in the waters.”

48 Brahmā said: “The Nārāyaṇa who lies in the waters and dwells in the beings — in all these forms He is Your portion. What I say is true.

49 Kāraṇodakaśāyī, Garbhodakaśāyī and Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu create through māyā; therefore all of Them are *māyī*, masters of māyā.[19]

50 These three, who lie on the waters, dwell within all as the Supersoul: They who are called Puruṣas are the Self of all the universes.[20]

51 Garbhodakaśāyī is the Self of Hiraṇyagarbha, and Kṣīrodakaśāyī is the Indweller of each individual being.[21]

52 They glance upon māyā, and in this there is, as it were, a trace of māyā; but Kṛṣṇa, who abides in the fourth state (*turīya*), has no connection with māyā at all.[22]

53 “Virāṭ, Hiraṇyagarbha and Kāraṇa are designations of the Lord; that which is free from these three is called the fourth (*turīya*).” (Śrīdhara Svāmī’s commentary on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.15.16)[23]

54 Although the three have dealings with māyā, she does not touch Them: all of Them are beyond māyā.[24]

55 “This is the lordship of the Lord: though He abides within material nature, He is never affected by its qualities — just as the intelligence of those who have taken shelter of Him is not affected.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.11.38)

56 You are the supreme shelter of those three; You are the original Nārāyaṇa — what doubt can there be?

57 The source of those three is the Nārāyaṇa of the spiritual sky. He is Your manifestation (*prakāśa*), and You are the original Nārāyaṇa.”[25]

58 Thus, by Brahmā’s words, the Nārāyaṇa of the spiritual sky is a manifestation of Kṛṣṇa. This is the explanation of the truth.[26]

59 This verse (2.30), which reveals the characteristics of the Truth, is the essence of the *Bhāgavatam*; as a rule of interpretation (*paribhāṣā*) it applies everywhere.[27]

60 Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān are manifestations of Kṛṣṇa. Not knowing this meaning, fools interpret otherwise.[28]

61 They say: “Nārāyaṇa is the source of the avatāras, and Kṛṣṇa is His avatāra; for That One has four arms, while this One has a human form.”

62 In this way they raise various objections, but a verse of the *Bhāgavatam* skilfully refutes them.

63 “The knowers of the Truth call the non-dual knowledge the Truth; it is named Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.2.11)[29]

64 Hear, brothers, and consider the meaning of this verse: the principal Truth is one, and It is manifest in three ways.

65 The non-dual knowledge, the Truth itself, is Kṛṣṇa's own form; Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān are His three forms.[30]

66 The meaning of this verse has left you speechless. Now hear another statement of the *Bhāgavatam*.

67 "All these (avatāras) are portions (*aṁśa*) and parts of portions (*kalā*) of the Puruṣa, but Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. Age after age They bring happiness to the world when it is troubled by the enemies of Indra." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.3.28)[31]

68 Describing the general characteristics of all the avatāras, he counted Kṛṣṇacandra among them.

69 Then Sūta Gosāñi, feeling great apprehension in his mind, determined the distinguishing characteristic of each.

70 All the avatāras are portions and parts of the Puruṣa, but Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself, the crown of all.

71 An opponent says: "Your explanation is fine, but the Nārāyaṇa of the spiritual sky is Bhagavān Himself.

72 It is He who comes and descends in the form of Kṛṣṇa. This is the meaning I see in the verse — what more is there to consider?"

73 To him I say: "Why do you draw inferences by false logic? A meaning contrary to scripture can never be evidence.

74 ‘One should not state the predicate without first stating the subject; for nothing that has not found its footing can stand anywhere.’ (Ekādaśī-tattva, 13)[32]

75 Without stating the subject one does not state the predicate: first the subject is stated, and afterwards the predicate.

76 That which is unknown is called the predicate (*vidheya*); that which is known is called the subject (*anuvāda*).

77 For example, we say: “This brāhmaṇa is a great scholar.” Here “brāhmaṇa” is the subject, and its predicate is “scholarship”.

78 That he is a brāhmaṇa is known, but his scholarship is not; therefore “brāhmaṇa” comes first, and “scholarship” afterwards.

79 In the same way, here the avatāras are all known, but whose avatāras They are — that is unknown.

80 First, by the word “these”, the avatāras are stated as the subject; afterwards the predicate is given: “portions of the Puruṣa”.[33]

81 So too Kṛṣṇa became known among the avatāras, but the particular knowledge of Him remained unknown.

82 Therefore the word “Kṛṣṇa” comes first, as the subject, and afterwards the predicate is stated: that He is “Bhagavān Himself”.

83 Thus it is established that Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself; and it follows of necessity that Bhagavān Himself is Kṛṣṇa.

84 If Kṛṣṇa were the portion and Nārāyaṇa the source, Sūta’s statement would have been the reverse.

85 He would have said: “Nārāyaṇa, the source, is Bhagavān Himself, and He is Śrī Kṛṣṇa.”

86 In the words of the wise seers there are none of these faults: error, inattention, the wish to deceive, and imperfection of the senses.[34]

87 You speak against the scriptures and grow angry when this is pointed out. The fault in your interpretation is that the predicate is wrongly placed (*avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa*).[35]

88 He from whose Godhood the Godhood of all others proceeds — in Him alone the words “Bhagavān Himself” have their meaning.

89 As many lamps are kindled from one lamp, and that one I count as the original,[36]

90 so Kṛṣṇa is the cause of all the avatāras. Hear another verse, which refutes wrong interpretations.

91–92 “In this *Bhāgavatam* there are ten subjects: primary creation (*sarga*), secondary creation (*visarga*), maintenance (*sthāna*), the Lord’s favour to His devotees (*poṣaṇa*), the impulses to action (*ūti*), the reigns of Manu (*manvantara*), the narrations of the Lord (*īśānukathā*), the winding up of the world (*nirodha*), liberation (*mukti*) and the shelter (*āśraya*). To reveal clearly the tenth, the great souls describe here the characteristics of the other nine — sometimes in prayers and narratives, sometimes by direct explanation.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.10.1–2)[37]

93 To make the shelter known I have named these nine categories; the cause from which these nine arise — that is what “the shelter” means.

94 Kṛṣṇa alone is the shelter of all; Kṛṣṇa is the abode of all. In Kṛṣṇa's body all the universes rest.

95 "In the Tenth Canto the tenth subject is revealed: the embodiment of the shelter of all who take shelter, the supreme abode named Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the abode of the world. To That I bow down." (Śrīdhara Svāmī, *Bhāvārtha-dīpikā* on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.1.1)

96 One who knows Kṛṣṇa's own form and His three potencies is no longer ignorant of Kṛṣṇa.

97 Kṛṣṇa's own form has six kinds of pastime forms (*vilāsa*): His manifestations are of two kinds, *prābhava* and *vaibhava*;[38]

98 His avatāras are of two kinds, partial (*aṁśa*) and empowered (*śaktyāveśa*); and His pastimes are of two kinds, those of childhood (*bālya*) and of boyhood (*paugaṇḍa*).[39]

99 Kṛṣṇa in His own form is youthful (*kiśora*): He Himself is the source of the avatāras. In these six forms He sports, filling the universe.

100 Within these six forms there are unlimited varieties; yet in all those unlimited forms there is one form, and no difference at all.

101 The spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*) is also called the personal potency (*svarūpa-śakti*) and the internal potency (*antaraṅgā*); her opulence is the unlimited abodes, such as the Vaikuṇṭhas.[40]

102 The potency māyā, the external potency, is the cause of the world: her opulence is the unlimited multitude of universes.

103 The potency of the souls, called marginal (*taṭasthā*), has no end. These are the three principal potencies, and their varieties are unlimited.

104 Such are His personal forms and His three potencies. Kṛṣṇa is the shelter of them all; in Kṛṣṇa they all abide.

105 Although the Puruṣa is the shelter of the universes, Kṛṣṇa is the original shelter of all — of the Puruṣas and the rest.

106 Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself; Kṛṣṇa is the shelter of all. All the scriptures declare Kṛṣṇa to be the Supreme Lord.

107 "Kṛṣṇa, Govinda, is the Supreme Lord; His form is eternal being, knowledge and bliss. He has no beginning, yet He is the beginning of all, the cause of all causes." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.1)

108 You know all these conclusions well, and yet you raise objections, only to unsettle me.[41]

109 That Kṛṣṇa, the source of all avatāras, the son of the king of Vraja, has Himself descended in the form of Caitanya.

110 Therefore Caitanya Gosāñi is the furthest limit of the Supreme Truth. To call Him Kṣīrodaśāyī — what glory is that to Him?[42]

111 Yet such words of a devotee are not wrong: everything is possible in Him, for He is the source of the avatāras.

112 All the avatāras are present in the body of their source; so each speaks of Him in his own way, according to his understanding.

113 Some call Kṛṣṇa Nara-Nārāyaṇa; others say that Kṛṣṇa is Vāmana Himself.

114 Some say that Kṛṣṇa is an avatāra of Kṣīrodaśāyī. Nothing of this is impossible; the words of all of them are true.

115 Some call Him Nārāyaṇa, Hari of the spiritual sky. Everything is possible in Kṛṣṇa, for He is the source of the avatāras.

116 I bow down at the feet of all my listeners: hear all these conclusions with undivided attention.

117 Do not be indifferent to them, thinking them mere doctrine; from them the mind becomes firmly attached to Kṛṣṇa.

118 Through all these conclusions I come to know the greatness of Caitanya; and from knowing His greatness the mind becomes firm and attached to Him.[43]

119 To tell the greatness of Caitanya Prabhu, I have described the greatness of Kṛṣṇa in detail.

120 This is the determination of the truth of Caitanya Gosāñi: He is Bhagavān Himself, Kṛṣṇa, the son of the king of Vraja.

121 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. *Anubhāṣya*: *bālaḥ* — “an inexperienced child”; the crocodiles are the mutually contending doctrines of Aulūkya, Jina, Buddha, Jaimini, Patañjali, Gautama, Kaṇāda, Kapila, Śaṅkara, Dattātreya and others; by the Lord’s mercy even the inexperienced one sets them aside as straw and comes to know the pure feet of Kṛṣṇa. ↩

2. *Anubhāṣya*: the swans, cakravākas and bees are pure devotees in different moods (*bhāva*), for whom these pastimes are a place of supreme joy; the murmur of the river is the sweet, indistinct sound of the stream of Śrī Hari's pastimes, sung by His devotees. ↩
3. Indicating the Object (*vastu-nirdeśa*) is one of the three kinds of auspicious invocation (Ādi 1.22). In the edition the verse is headed: "explanation of the third of the first fourteen verses — indicating the Object". ↩
4. The same verse as Ādi 1.3. *Anubhāṣya*: Brahman is the radiance of His transcendental body, and the Paramātmā a particular manifestation of His majesty; both are only two aspects of His form, perceived according to the capacity of the seer — not the fullness of the Lord, as Bhagavān is. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: "He whom they call Bhagavān, the shelter and source of Brahman and Paramātmā, is my Lord, Bhagavān Himself." ↩
5. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: by the rules of rhetoric one first names the *anuvāda*, the known, and then the *vidheya*, the new. That Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān exist is known from the Vedas; that Brahman is the effulgence of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya's body, Paramātmā His portion and Bhagavān He Himself, is not yet known — and this is what is stated. ↩
6. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: "The conclusion of the scriptures is this: the supreme truth of *viṣṇu-tattva* is Bhagavān Himself, Kṛṣṇacandra." ↩
7. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the first realisation of that non-dual knowledge is Brahman, the second Paramātmā, the third Bhagavān. ↩
8. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: "… the Brahman distinct from the unlimited opulences — earths and the rest — in millions upon millions of universes, undivided, infinite and complete, has arisen from the effulgence of that original Person, Govinda." ↩
9. *Anubhāṣya*: with this verse it is shown that attaining Kṛṣṇa's feet is easy, whereas renunciants who labour hard attain, as the fruit of their practice, only the realm of Brahman; *vāta-vasanāḥ* — naked; *śramaṇāḥ* — mendicants who emaciate the body; *brahmākhyam* — featureless. ↩
10. *Anubhāṣya*: the Puruṣa who dwells within is the Paramātmā, "only a manifestation of a portion (*aṁśa-vibhūti*) of Govinda"; the three Puruṣa-avatāras govern the material world, while Bhagavān Himself, abiding in the fourth, *turīya*, is attached to none of its affairs. ↩
11. *Anubhāṣya*: the one Śrī Govinda, ever manifest in Goloka-Vṛndāvana, appears in the hearts of countless souls as the Paramātmā, the Person whom the soul is to serve. ↩

12. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “by one portion, as the Paramātmā, I have entered and abide in the whole world.” ↩
13. *Anubhāṣya*: *bheda-mohaḥ* — the illusion that the Lord’s forms (*prakāśa*, *vilāsa*) differ in name, form, qualities and pastimes; *ātma-kalpitānām* — “created by Himself”. Reference to the *Bhāgavatam* as in the edition. ↩
14. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: by the word *sākṣāt* (“directly, Himself”) the author establishes that Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is Govinda Himself, not His *prakāśa* or *vilāsa*. ↩
15. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the eternal form of the Lord cannot be seen by material senses or by the efforts of knowledge; through bhakti, through love, only the devotees become fit to see it — as the gods, whose divine eyes pierce the net of the sun’s rays, see the sun’s own form. ↩
16. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «চারি হাত» (another spelling: «হাথ»). ↩
17. *Anubhāṣya*: the verse gives three meanings of the name Nārāyaṇa, corresponding to the three Puruṣa-avatāras: “the Self of all the embodied” (*nāra* — the aggregate of souls, *ayana* — their shelter) is Kṣīrodakaśāyī; “the witness of all the worlds” (*ayase* — “You know”) is Garbhodakaśāyī; “He whose abode is the waters born of Nara” is Kāraṇodakaśāyī. All of Them are Your portions, and You are the original Nārāyaṇa. “Not māyā” — not transient like what māyā produces: māyā cannot touch Your spiritual body, even in the avatāras. ↩
18. This is the first reason why Kṛṣṇa is the original Nārāyaṇa: *nāra* — all souls, *ayana* — their shelter (2.38). *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the material creation lies within māyā (*Gītā* 7.4–5). ↩
19. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “Because They create through māyā, these three Puruṣas are *māyī*, that is, lords in relation to māyā.” Māyā does not touch Them (2.54). ↩
20. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *ye puruṣa-nāmī* — “They whose name is Puruṣa”. The Self of the universes in this verse is all three of Them: Kāraṇodakaśāyī of all the universes together, Garbhodakaśāyī of the aggregate of beings in a universe, Kṣīrodakaśāyī of each individual being (2.51). ↩
21. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Hiraṇyagarbha is the aggregate of beings (*samaṣṭi*); its Indweller is Garbhodakaśāyī; the Indweller of each separate being (*vyaṣṭi*) is Kṣīrodakaśāyī. ↩
22. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: beyond the three Puruṣas is the *turīya*, “the fourth”: Nārāyaṇa, Lord of the spiritual sky, the *vilāsa* of Kṛṣṇacandra, utterly free from any trace of māyā; and the Puruṣas, as it says on 2.54, “only cast Their glance upon māyā, but do not touch it”. ↩

23. *Anubhāṣya*: Virāṭ is the gross, Hiraṇyagarbha the subtle, Kāraṇa — ignorance or *prakṛti*; these are particular manifestations (*upādhi*) of the Puruṣa-avatāra, the creator of the *mahat*; the *turīya*, free from them, is Vaikuṇṭha, beyond the three Puruṣas. Śrīdhara Svāmī cites this verse to explain the word *turīya*. ↩
24. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Hiraṇyagarbha and the other beings, collective and individual, are under māyā; the three Puruṣas, though dealing with her, are beyond her — They are lords of māyā; They glance at her, but do not touch her. ↩
25. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «তেঁহ তোমার প্রকাশ» — “He is Your manifestation”. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Nārāyaṇa of the spiritual sky is the source of the Puruṣa-avatāras; He is “Your secondary manifestation (*gauṇa-prakāśa*) in the form of *vilāsa*”. *Anubhāṣya*: His *vilāsa* is the fourfold form — Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha — from whom the three Puruṣas appear. ↩
26. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «তেঁহ কৃষ্ণের প্রকাশ» (another reading: «তেঁহো কৃষ্ণের বিলাস»). In meaning this manifestation is a *vilāsa*: on 2.57 the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* calls Nārāyaṇa “a secondary manifestation in the form of *vilāsa*”. ↩
27. *Anubhāṣya*: “this verse” is the one quoted above (2.30), “Are You not Nārāyaṇa…”. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *paribhāṣā* — a governing rule: “this characteristic you will find everywhere in the *Bhāgavatam*”. ↩
28. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *vihāra* — a manifestation (*prakāśa*) for His pastimes. ↩
29. The same verse as 2.11 (so the *Anubhāṣya* also notes). ↩
30. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “non-dual knowledge” in this verse is the original Reality, Kṛṣṇa’s own form. ↩
31. *Anubhāṣya*: *ete* — “the avatāras named before”; *aṁśāḥ* — portions of the Puruṣa-avatāra, *kalāḥ* — portions of portions; *mṛḍayanti*, “make happy”, refers to these avatāras. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “Rāma, Nṛsiṁha and others are portions or parts of the Puruṣa; They protect the world oppressed by demons.” ↩
32. The reference is as in the edition: “a rule of rhetoric, *Ekādaśī-tattva*, 13”. ↩
33. This refers to verse 2.67 (*ete cāṁśa-kalāḥ puṁsaḥ*). ↩
34. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *bhrama* — false knowledge; *pramāda* — inattention; *vipralipsā* — the mind straying elsewhere; *karaṇāpāṭava* — the imperfection of the senses. ↩

35. *Anubhāṣya*: the fault *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa* (“an unconsidered predicate”) arises when the unknown is not set forth as the principal statement; it is also called *vidheyāvimarśa*. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: it occurs when the predicate is stated before the subject. ↩
36. *Anubhāṣya* cites the *Brahma-saṁhitā*, 5.46: a flame passed on to another lamp shines just as the first; so Govinda appears as Viṣṇu. All the forms of Viṣṇu are like lamps, equal in light to the original Nārāyaṇa, yet they shine from the original lamp. ↩
37. According to the *Anubhāṣya*: *ūti* — karmic desires; *manvantara* — the righteous path given by Manu; *īśānukathā* — the accounts of Hari’s avatāras; *nirodha* — the Lord with His potencies lying down in sleep; *mukti* — abiding in one’s pure nature; *āśraya* — the Supreme Brahman, the cause of creation, maintenance and dissolution. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the nine are described “sometimes through prayers and narratives, sometimes by direct analysis”. In the edition these are two verses (2.91 and 2.92). ↩
38. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *prābhava* and *vaibhava* are those forms whose eternal form of being, knowledge and bliss is like Hari’s, yet somewhat less than the Supreme; according to the degree of potency, where lordship (*prabhutā*) predominates they are called *prābhava*, and where all-pervading greatness (*vibhutā*) predominates, *vaibhava*. ↩
39. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the *aṁśa* and *śaktyāveśa* avatāras are described elsewhere; they too are counted among the *prābhava* and *vaibhava*. Kṛṣṇa, who is eternally youthful, has pastimes in both childhood and boyhood (AP on 2.99). ↩
40. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *cit-śakti* is another name of the *svarūpa-śakti*, the internal potency; from her come the unlimited manifestations of opulence in Vaikuṇṭha and the other abodes; from the marginal *jīva-śakti* — unlimited souls, bound and liberated; from the external māyā — the unlimited opulence of the material universes. ↩
41. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *cālāite* — “to cause needless agitation”. ↩
42. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: in some books Śrī Caitanya is called Kṣīrodaśāyī, the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha; that does not describe His glory fully, yet the words of those devotees are not false (2.111): Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, non-different from Kṛṣṇa, is Himself the source of the avatāras, and all the avatāras are present in Him. The *Anubhāṣya* cites the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Madhya 6.95): “I was lying in the Milk Ocean; My sleep was broken by Nāḍā’s (Advaita’s) roar.” ↩
43. The *Anubhāṣya* cites the *Pañcarātra*: “Firm affection, greater than all else and joined with knowledge of the Lord’s greatness, is called bhakti”; and: “On

the path of rules it is joined with knowledge of His greatness; for those who follow the path of spontaneous love it is mostly pure (affection) alone.” ↩